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December 5, 1972
SUPERSEDING
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December 31, 1970

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

MARKER, TUBE TYPE: WHITE

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers a tube type valve action marker with white ink.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PPP-B-566 - Boxes; Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-665 - Boxes; Paperboard, Metal Edged and Components.
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Setup.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141/GEN(General Provisions) - Paint, Varnish, Lacquer, and Related Materials; Methods of Inspection, Sampling, and Testing.
Fed. Test Method 141/4061 - Drying Time of Coatings.
Fed. Test Method 141/4121 - Dry Opacity.
Fed. Test Method 141/4250 - Color of Pigmented Coatings.
Fed. Test Method 141/4282 - Viscosity of Pigmented Materials (Ford Cup).
Fed. Test Method 141/4293 - Flash Point of Pigmented Materials (Pensky-Martens Closed Cup Tester).
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specification procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

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Laws and Regulations:

21CFR191 - Hazardous Substances: Definitions and Procedural and Interpretative Regulations. (Food and Drug Administration.)

(The Code of Federal Regulations (CFR) and the Federal Register (FR) are for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402. When indicated, reprints of certain regulations may be obtained from the Federal agency responsible for issuance thereof.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Incorporated, Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Association, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, Illinois 60606.)

Technical society and technical association specifications and standards are generally available for reference from libraries. They are also distributed among technical groups and using Federal agencies.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Compliance with Federal Law. Each marker shall be labeled in accordance with the applicable requirements of 21CFR191 (see 4.1.2).

3.2 Materials. The manufacturer is given wide latitude in his selection of materials and process of manufacture provided the product meets the requirements of this specification.

3.3 Design and construction. The marker shall be of the tube or cannister type, free liquid filled (without absorbent material), nonrefillable, designed to operate by valve action and shall produce white marking as specified in 3.5. The marker shall be constructed to provide protection against evaporation and leakage, and shall have a minimum ink content of 1/2 liquid ounce (14.786 milliliters) when tested as specified in 4.4.1. The marker shall be equipped with a tight fitting protective cap, and the cap or barrel may be equipped with a pocket clip at the option of the manufacturer. One or more mixing balls shall be included within the barrel.

3.3.1 Dimensions. The overall length of the marker, with cap in place, shall be not more than 5-1/2 inches, and the outside diameter of the marker tube shall be not more than 1 inch.

3.3.2 Barrel (reservoir). The marker barrel or reservoir may be made of plastic, metal, or glass, or a combination of these materials. The barrel shall be constructed so that the ink will emerge only through the writing tip.

3.3.3 Writing tip. The writing tip may be made of any material suitable for the intended purpose.

3.3.4 Valve. The valve may be made of any suitable material, and shall be positioned between the ink supply and the writing tip to control the ink flow.

3.4 Performance characteristics.

3.4.1 Writing characteristics. The marker shall produce lines free from splits and not less than 1/16 inch in width when tested as specified in 4.4.2 and 4.4.3.

3.4.2 Drying time. Ink applied at a wet-film thickness of not less than 0.001 inch shall set-to-touch within 2 minutes when tested as specified in 4.1.1.

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3.4.3 Dry opacity. Dried film of ink applied at a wet-film thickness of .002 inch shall show a minimum contrast ratio of 0.90 when tested as specified in 4.1.1.

3.4.4 Viscosity. Viscosity shall be not less than 14 seconds when tested as specified in 4.1.1.

3.4.5 Flash point. Flash point shall be not less than 45°F. when tested as specified in 4.1.1.

3.5 Color of ink. Color of ink shall be semigloss white, color number 27875, Federal Std. No. 595 (see 4.1.1).

3.6 Finish. The finish of the barrel and cap shall be the manufacturer's commercial practice provided the color of ink (white) is identified.

3.7 Identification marking. The marker shall be marked in a legible manner with the manufacturer's name, or trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture can be readily determined.

3.8 Prohibited ingredients. The marker shall contain no benzol (benzene), aniline oil, chlorinated compounds, or other toxic or hydrolyzable chlorine derivatives (see 4.1.2).

3.9 Shelf life. The marker shall be able to meet all the requirements of this specification from time of delivery to a minimum of 12 months in storage.

3.10 Workmanship. Markers shall be free from imperfections or defects which might affect their serviceability or durability.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Production testing. Production testing shall consist of (1) established formula testing, and (2) plant control testing, as follows:

4.1.1.1 Established formula testing. Prior to the first shipment under the contract, the supplier shall conduct the following established formula testing. Retesting shall be conducted in the event of formula change during the contract period.

Dry opacity. Determine the dry opacity (see 3.4.3) in accordance with procedure B of method 4121 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141.

Flash point. Determine the flash point (see 3.4.5) in accordance with method 4293 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141.

Color. Comparison of the color of the ink with that of the color chip specified in 3.5 shall be conducted in the following manner: Apply a film of the sample ink at complete hiding to a nonporous panel and allow to dry completely. Place the panel beside the specified color chip and compare visually under illumination in accordance with method 4250 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141.

4.1.1.2 Plant control testing. The supplier shall conduct the following testing on each production run of liquid ink prior to transfer to the marker filling area or department. For the purpose of this specification, a production run shall be limited to 100 gallons of ink.

Drying time. Determine the drying time (see 3.4.2) in accordance with the air drying procedure of method 4061 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141.

Viscosity. Determine the viscosity (see 3.4.4) in accordance with method 4282 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 141.

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4.1.1.3 Reports of production testing. In lieu of using his own facilities, the supplier may submit a report of production testing from a laboratory acceptable to the Government as evidence of compliance with the specification requirements. The supplier shall maintain records of production testing. These records shall be available to the authorized Government representative, and shall include: (1) Name and address of the laboratory which conducted the test, (2) name of test and date, (3) Test data (results), and (4) quantity of material represented by the test report.

4.1.2 Certification of compliance. Prior to the first shipment under the contract, the supplier shall furnish the contracting officer a certification that the markers contain no prohibited ingredient defined in 3.8, and applicable requirements of 21CFR191 have been complied with (see 3.1). A recertification shall be submitted in the event of a change in formulation of ink or marking media during the contract period.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 Lot. For purpose of sampling, a lot shall consist of all markers presented for inspection at one time as defined in MIL-STD-105.

4.2.2 Sampling of end-item for visual defects. A random sample of markers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one marker.

4.2.3 Sampling for preparation for delivery requirements. For examination of interior packages the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, and selected at random just prior to the closing operation. Sampling shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105. Closure defects shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end-item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective.

4.2.4 Sampling for end-item tests. A random sample of markers shall be taken from each lot in accordance with MIL-STD-105, inspection level S-1. The AQL shall not exceed 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be two markers.

4.3 Examination.

4.3.1 Visual examination of end-item. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.2 shall be examined for defects listed in table I.

4.3.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. Sample taken in accordance with 4.2.3 shall be examined to determine that packaging, packing, and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II.

TABLE I. Classification of marker defects

Examine	Defects
Design and construction	Marker not non-refillable type; not valve operated; cap not tight fitting; evidence of leakage (3.3).
Dimensions	Overall length (with cap in place) more than 5-1/2 inches, or outside diameter of tube more than 1 inch (3.3.1).
Finish	Color of ink not identified on marker (3.6).
Identification marking	Marker not legibly marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark (3.7).
Workmanship	Any defects which impair serviceability or affect appearance (3.10).

TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defects
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, or distortion of containers.

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4.4 End-item tests. Samples taken in accordance with 4.2.4 shall be subjected to the following end-item tests. Unless otherwise specified, the tests shall be made at room temperature of 21° to 32°C. (70° to 90°F.). Referee testing shall be conducted in an atmosphere of 23° ± 2°C. (73.4 ± 3.6°F.) and at a relative humidity of 50 ± 5 percent. Tests involving writing shall be conducted with the marker held at an angle of 50° to 90° from the horizontal and with a normal writing pressure or a pressure recommended by the manufacturer.

4.4.1 Ink content. Measure the volume of ink using a buret.

4.4.2 Writing characteristics. Select an unused sample marker, uncap and actuate valve so that ink is present on the writing tip (pre-test lines may be drawn to start the flow of ink). Draw three 6-inch lines on a clean glass panel and check for compliance with 3.4.1. Tightly recap the marker and allow to stand with tip up for 24 hours.

4.4.3 Writing characteristics (after 24 hours standing). At the end of the 24 hours standing, repeat the test specified in 4.4.2.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Twelve (12) markers shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-665, or PPP-B-676. Glass-bodied markers shall be separated by full-depth slotted partitions to provide additional protection. The box shall be closed in accordance with the applicable specification or appendix thereto.

5.1.2 Level B. Twelve (12) markers shall be packaged as specified in 5.1.1.

5.1.3 Level C. Markers shall be packaged in accordance with the supplier's commercial practice, providing that this insures protection for the markers during shipment and safe delivery to their destination.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Thirty six unit packages (432 markers) shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. The box shall be closed in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B. Thirty six unit packages (432 markers) shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1 except the box shall be class domestic.

5.2.3 Level C. Markers packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed in containers to assure carrier acceptance and safe arrival at destination in compliance with National Motor Freight Classification or Uniform Freight Classification.

5.3 Marking (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, the unit package and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123. Additionally, the unit package and shipping container shall be marked with a lot, batch or production control number and the date of pack (month and year) in accordance with the special marking requirements of Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order the unit package and shipping container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. The marker covered by this specification is intended for use in freehand marking, writing, drawing, and identification marking on various types of material.

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6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Levels of packaging, packing, and any special marking for shipment required (see 5.1, 5.2 and 5.3).

NO OFFICIAL DOD INTEREST HAS BEEN REGISTERED

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 10 cents each.

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